Medical Necessity and Clinical Review Guide

Synthetic training document for an educational RAG project. This is not an official Aetna policy or plan document.

Medical Necessity

Medical necessity review evaluates whether a requested service is clinically appropriate based on the member's condition, clinical documentation, treatment history, and applicable criteria.

Clinical Review Inputs

Reviewers may consider diagnosis, symptoms, prior treatments, imaging or laboratory findings, severity, duration, and whether less intensive alternatives have been attempted.

Escalation

Cases that do not clearly meet criteria or that involve complex clinical judgment may be escalated for physician review.

RAG Use

A knowledge assistant may retrieve relevant criteria and summarize supporting documentation, but final clinical decisions should not be made solely by the language model.

Example Clinical Review Checklist

Review Item	Example Evidence	Required?
Diagnosis	Documented diagnosis code and notes	Yes
Prior treatment	Medication/therapy history	Often
Objective findings	Lab or imaging result	Depends on service
Alternative therapy	Less intensive option attempted	Sometimes
Physician review	Clinical escalation	For ambiguous cases